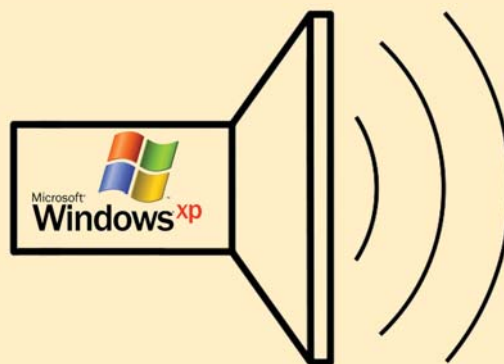


How would you create custom sound events in Windows XP?

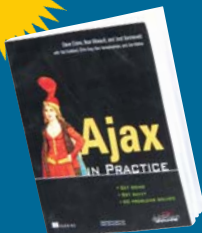
Send in your solution with the subject "Take a Crack", and your postal address, to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com

Add Sound Events To XP



LAST MONTH'S CHALLENGE

Win!



Take a Crack and win

PC Upgrade & Repair Street Smarts

by Dave Crane, Bear Bibeault and Jord Sonneveld

WILEY-INDIA

LAST MONTH'S WINNER

R Vinod
Salem, Tamil Nadu

Rules and Regulations

Readers are requested to send in their answers by the 15th of the month of publication.

Employees of Jasubhai Digital Media and their relatives are not permitted to participate in this contest.

Readers are encouraged to send their replies by e-mail. Jasubhai Digital Media will not entertain any unsolicited communication.

Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are trying to solve the problem.

Boot Into XP Using A Floppy!

Last Month's Solution

Last month's challenge was to boot into XP using a floppy disk. Here's how to do it.

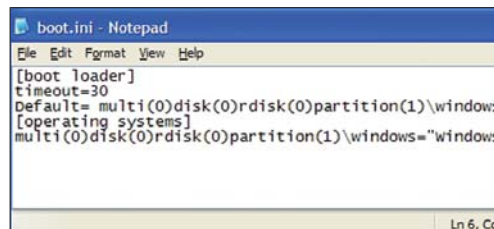
First format a floppy disk using XP's format utility: open My Computer, right-click the floppy icon, and select Format.

Copy the files `ntldr` and `ntdetect.com` from the `i386` folder in the Windows XP CD to the root of the floppy disk. Then create a file called "boot.ini" in the root of the floppy disk to contain information corresponding to the computer which you want to boot using the floppy. The boot.ini file should look something like this:



Format the Floppy

```
[boot loader]
timeout = 30
default =
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINDOWS
[operating systems]
multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\WINDOWS = "Microsoft Windows XP Professional" /fastdetect
```



Create or copy Boot.ini

If XP is installed in any directory other than "Windows", say "x", the third line must read:

```
default = multi(0)
disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\x
```

and the fifth line must read:
`multi(0)disk(0)rdisk(0)partition(1)\x = "Microsoft Windows XP Professional" /fastdetect`

Also, in the third and fifth lines, in `partition(y)`, `y` indicates the partition number in which XP has been installed. Change it to the appropriate value. To find the exact values for your system, in XP, right-click My Computer and click on Manage. Click Disk Management in the left pane. Now you will be able to view all the drives and their partitions on the right-hand side, look at the bottom right part of the window. Each drive is labelled; there is the drive letter along with the drive name, in the next line you will see the drive capacity and the file-system and in the

last line, you will see the health status. Observe this last line for each drive and in one of the drive, you will see the status as Healthy (System). This is the boot partition where XP resides. Note the disk number, say X, at the right of this drive, this is the value which you should put in the `rdisk(X)`. You will be graphically able to find the partition number by counting the partition from left. If the system partition is the first then you should use `partition(1)`, if it is second then it will be `partition(2)`, and so on.

If the computer boots from a SCSI hard disk, `multi(0)` must be replaced by `scsi(x)`, where `x` depends upon the adapter specified in the SCSI driver. If the `scsi(x)` option has been made use of in the `boot.ini` file, copy the device driver for the SCSI controller and put it in the root of the floppy disk, along with the three other files, and rename it to `ntbootdd.sys`.

In the case of SCSI hard disks, in the third and fifth lines, in `disc(z)`, `z` represents the SCSI-ID of the hard disk that must be booted into. Change it to the appropriate value. ■